

RTI State Routing Reference

Jurisdiction, portals, and filing mode by state — for the correct-authority routing feature

Master Reference

The Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT) maintains the official state-link directory listing First Appellate Authorities, PIOs, and each state's RTI mechanism:

rti.gov.in/rtistatelink.html (mirrored at rti.dopt.gov.in/rtistatelink.html)

The Single Most Important Routing Rule

■ **The Central portal (rtionline.gov.in) is for Central Government Ministries/Departments/PSUs ONLY. State-authority RTIs filed there — including for Delhi (NCT) specifically — are returned without refund.**

This Central-vs-State jurisdiction mistake is the single most common filing error the fragmented system causes today. It should be the first check your routing logic performs, before anything else.

The Underlying Reality

Only around 6 states currently have functioning online RTI portals. The rest require offline filing (post / IPO / demand draft / cash) even though the RTI Act itself is a national law. Your routing tool's job isn't just picking a URL — it's telling the user whether online filing is even possible for their state, and what offline steps replace it if not.

Confirmed Online Portals (hardcode these for the demo)

Jurisdiction	Portal URL	Notes
Central Govt (all Ministries/PSUs)	rtionline.gov.in	Not for State authorities, incl. Delhi NCT
Uttar Pradesh	rtionline.up.gov.in	State-only filings
Kerala	rtiportal.kerala.gov.in	State-only filings
Himachal Pradesh	onlinerti.hp.gov.in	State-only filings
Chhattisgarh	rtionline.cg.gov.in	Portal exists; postal still often faster
Rajasthan	rti.rajasthan.gov.in	State-only filings
Jammu & Kashmir	rtionline.jk.gov.in	Launched Dec 2024, NIC-built

Route to Postal Filing Instead

Jurisdiction	Guidance
Uttarakhand	Portal exists but reportedly unreliable — postal is faster
Jharkhand	Post only for reliable delivery
Goa, Sikkim	Postal filing
A&N; Islands, Lakshadweep, Puducherry, DNH & DD, Chandigarh	UT administrations — route to UT Secretariat address

Fee & Timeline Variation (for the reply-quality / expectation-setting feature)

Category	Detail
Cheapest fees	Tamil Nadu (Rs 10, Rs 0 for BPL), Karnataka (Rs 10), Kerala (Rs 10), Andhra Pradesh (Rs 10)
Most expensive fees	Punjab & Haryana (Rs 50 RTI fee, Rs 50 First Appeal fee) — also UP, MP
Fastest reply rates	Delhi (76% within 30 days), Karnataka (71%), Kerala (68%)
Information Commission backlog range	From ~3 months (Goa) to ~3 years (Uttar Pradesh)

Scoping Note

For the hackathon build, hardcode a lookup table covering roughly 6-8 states — the confirmed online-portal states above, plus 2-3 major postal-only states (e.g. Uttarakhand, Jharkhand) — rather than attempting all 28 states + 8 Union Territories. This is enough to prove the routing concept convincingly without exhaustive data collection under time pressure.

Compiled from DoPT/rtionline.gov.in official guidelines and current state RTI portal research. Verify each state's live portal status before final submission — rules and portal availability change.